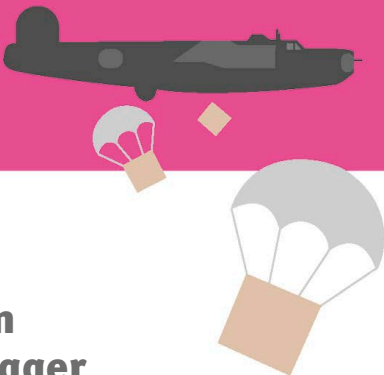




January

4

1944

Operation Carpetbagger

Allied forces carried out the first of more than 3,000 air missions to drop essential supplies and weapons. These items were delivered by parachute to resistance fighters across large parts of Nazi-occupied Europe.

1936

Topping the charts

US magazine *Billboard* published the first music hit parade – a list of the week's bestselling songs. More than 80 years later, it still releases weekly charts of the most popular songs and albums, as well as charts split by different types of music.

Born this day

1809 Louis Braille, French teacher. Totally blinded by a childhood accident, he designed the writing system named after him. Braille consists of raised dots on paper that visually impaired people can read with their fingers. Louis Braille's birthday is now celebrated as World Braille Day.

2010

Tower in the desert

The Burj Khalifa officially opened in Dubai in the United Arab Emirates. It stands about 828 m (2,717 ft) tall and has more than 160 floors.

Also on this day

1853 Solomon Northup was freed from slavery in Louisiana, USA. The memoir of his experiences, *Twelve Years a Slave*, was made into an award-winning film in 2013.

1906 South Africa's cricket team scored their first international test match win in a four-day game against England.

2007 Nancy Pelosi became the first woman Speaker of the House of Representatives in the USA.

